# Carim Panumpang, Sr.

Atty. **Carim L. Panumpang, Sr.** (also known as Atty. **Rex Panumpang**) was a prominently influential Filipino lawyer and government official whose career spanned public service, civil society leadership, and interfaith advocacy.

He is best remembered for his groundbreaking work bridging Islamic law with Philippine national jurisprudence, empowering Muslim Filipinos through legal protections, and advancing the Halal industry as a framework for religiously authentic entrepreneurship and economic inclusion.

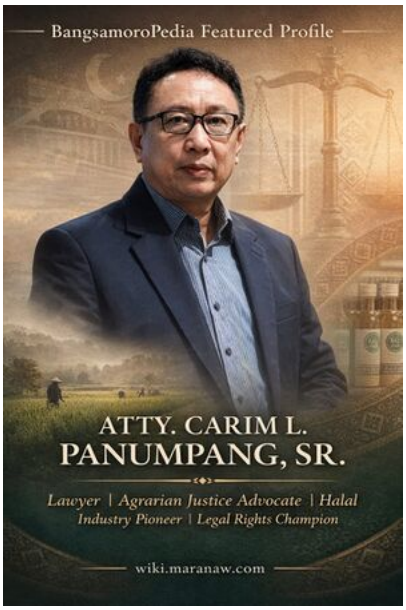
As the **Undersecretary for Special Concerns** at the Department of Agrarian Reform (DAR), Panumpang championed inclusive rural development and placed Muslim and women farmer voices at the center of land reform policy.

Through his leadership of the **Halal International Chamber of Commerce and Industries of the Philippines (HICCIP)** and the **Muslim Legal Aid Foundation Inc.**, he established institutional pathways for Muslim Filipinos to access culturally grounded legal services and participate in the global Halal economy.

His legacy is inseparable from his conviction that justice and prosperity for Muslim Filipinos must remain anchored in Shari'ah principles, national legal frameworks, and collaborative governance structures.

# Contents


1 Early Life and Education
2 Government Service at the Department of Agrarian Reform
  2.1 Appointment and Mandate
  2.2 Agrarian Justice and CLOA Validation
  2.3 Women Farmer Empowerment
  2.4 Support Services and Infrastructure
  2.5 Marawi Relief and BARMM Collaboration
3 Legal Advocacy and Shari'ah-Based Legal Pluralism
  3.1 Muslim Legal Aid Foundation Inc.
  3.2 Code of Muslim Personal Laws Advocacy
  3.3 Support for Shari'ah Bar and Legal Hybridity
4 Halal Industry Development and Shari'ah-Based Entrepreneurship
  4.1 Leadership of HICCIP
  4.2 Certification and Institutional Integrity
  4.3 Global Market Integration and Inclusive Entrepreneurship
5 Institutional Innovation and Community Organizing
  5.1 Networks and Diaspora Engagement
  5.2 Professional Training and Capacity Building
6 Legacy and Vision
7 Death
8 Recognition
9 Further Reading
10 See Also
11 References


**Atty. Carim L. Panumpang, Sr.**

| | |
|---|---|
| Full Name | Carim L. Panumpang, Sr. |
| Also Known As | Rex Panumpang |
| Birth | Information not publicly available |
| Death | August 2023 (exact date not publicly documented) |
| Ethnicity | Maranaw |
| Religion | Islam |
| Education | Law Degree (specific institution unconfirmed in available sources) |
| Occupation | Government Official, Lawyer, Civil Society Leader |
| Notable Positions | Undersecretary for Special Concerns (DAR); Chairman of HICCIP; President of Muslim Legal Aid Foundation Inc. |
| Primary Advocacy | Shari'ah-based legal pluralism; Muslim economic inclusion; Agrarian justice; Halal industry development |

# Early Life and Education

Little is publicly documented about Panumpang's early life, family background, or formal education.

However, his professional trajectory reveals a lawyer deeply committed to public service and Muslim community advocacy from his formative years onward.

His work across government, civil society, and religious institutions suggests he completed law school and undertook specialized training in agrarian law and Islamic jurisprudence, though specific details remain unverified in publicly available sources.

# Government Service at the Department of Agrarian Reform

## Appointment and Mandate

Panumpang served as **Undersecretary for Special Concerns** at the Department of Agrarian Reform during the administration of President Rodrigo Duterte.

His office was tasked with identifying and addressing systemic barriers affecting agrarian reform beneficiaries (ARBs), particularly marginalized and underserved populations including women farmers, Muslim communities in BARMM, and vulnerable rural families.

## Agrarian Justice and CLOA Validation

One of his most visible initiatives was spearheading nationwide **CLOA (Certificate of Land Ownership Award) Validation** activities.

This multi-year program systematically verified whether emancipation patents (EPs) and CLOAs issued under the Comprehensive Agrarian Reform Program (CARP) remained in the possession of their original beneficiaries and continued to be productively farmed.

Panumpang was explicit about the purpose: "The real objective of CARP is to develop agriculture. We award lots to beneficiaries and the colatilla [conditions] carried under this CLOA is for them to make the land productive."

He warned farmer-beneficiaries against selling their awarded lots and threatened blacklisting from future programs and repossession proceedings against lot buyers, emphasizing that agrarian parcels were meant to lift families out of poverty, not to be treated as tradeable assets.

## Women Farmer Empowerment

Throughout his tenure, Panumpang consistently advocated for the recognition of women as central actors in agrarian reform, not peripheral beneficiaries.

Speaking before over 600 participants during Women's Month celebrations, he highlighted DAR's initiatives in gender awareness and the inclusion of rural women in departmental services.

He repeatedly emphasized that women farmers possessed "enormous potential to improve food production" and were vital partners in nation-building.

This advocacy reflected his broader belief that inclusive development rooted in Shari'ah principles required centering women's agency and rights, consistent with Islamic teachings on women's economic participation and inheritance protections.

## Support Services and Infrastructure

Panumpang oversaw initiatives that moved beyond land distribution to comprehensive support services.

He championed the **Tulay ng Pangulo para sa Kaunlarang Pang-Agraryo** (President's Bridge Program), which constructed prefabricated steel bridges connecting farmlands to markets, addressing logistical barriers that prevented ARBs from reaching buyers.

He also supported programs designed to attract youth into agriculture, organizing "Stakeholders' Engagement with the Youth" and sponsoring film competitions like "PelikulAgraryo" to counter the Philippines' aging farming population and inspire younger generations to embrace agricultural careers.

### Marawi Relief and BARMM Collaboration

In 2021, Panumpang's Special Concerns Office served as lead convener for consultative meetings aimed at distributing government-owned lands in war-ravaged Marawi City to qualified farmer-beneficiaries.

He articulated a powerful vision of this work as "legitimizing the ownership of Marawi farmers over lands that they deserve to own a long time ago as part of their rights to their ancestral domain."

This statement encapsulated his philosophy: agrarian justice was inseparable from recognizing indigenous and ancestral claims rooted in Bangsamoro history and identity.

## Legal Advocacy and Shari'ah-Based Legal Pluralism

### Muslim Legal Aid Foundation Inc.

As **President of the Muslim Legal Aid Foundation Inc.** (commonly abbreviated as MUSLAID), Panumpang established an institutional mechanism for providing pro bono legal services to Muslim Filipinos facing systemic discrimination and marginalization.

The foundation's work centered on human rights cases and legal protections under Philippine and Islamic law, particularly addressing cases of mistaken identity in which innocent Muslims were arrested or detained due to profiling or shared names with suspects in high-profile crimes such as the Maguindanao Massacre.

His vision for MUSLAID transcended reactive defense; he saw it as a bridge institution that could educate Muslim Filipinos about their rights under both Presidential Decree No. 1083 (the Code of Muslim Personal Laws) and the Philippine Constitution, while simultaneously educating the broader legal system about Islamic jurisprudence and Muslim-specific vulnerabilities.

### Code of Muslim Personal Laws Advocacy

Panumpang was a vocal champion of **Presidential Decree No. 1083** (PDCL), which established the legal framework for Muslim Filipino autonomy in matters of marriage, divorce, inheritance, and family relations.

He consistently advocated for the PDCL as the primary legal resource for Muslim Filipinos in these domains, arguing that respect for religious self-determination was both a constitutional right and a practical necessity.

His legal work underscored the concept of **legal pluralism** (the coexistence of multiple legal systems within a single state) as a feature rather than a flaw of the Philippine legal order.

This placed him among a small cohort of Muslim Filipino legal scholars pushing for institutional recognition that justice for Muslim communities required honoring Shari'ah alongside civil law.

### Support for Shari'ah Bar and Legal Hybridity

Panumpang advocated for the establishment of a **Shari'ah Bar** in the Philippines, envisioning a cadre of lawyers trained in both Islamic jurisprudence and Philippine law who could represent Muslim clients with cultural and religious fluency.

He promoted the concept of **legal hybridity**, encouraging dialogue between the Supreme Court and Islamic scholars to harmonize Islamic law with Philippine national law in ways that honored both systems' integrity.

Through his partnerships with the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF), he supported the development of executive education programs in Halal Industry and Islamic Banking, creating a pipeline of locally trained technical personnel capable of implementing Shari'ah-based economic models.

## Halal Industry Development and Shari'ah-Based Entrepreneurship

### Leadership of HICCIP

Panumpang served as **Chairman of the Halal International Chamber of Commerce and Industries of the Philippines (HICCIP)**, the premier government-recognized Halal certification body in the Philippines.

HICCIP was established on June 26, 2013, with the mission of encouraging investments and partnerships in Halal-based businesses while ensuring the authenticity and credibility of Philippine Halal-certified products for local and international Muslim consumers.

Under Panumpang's leadership, HICCIP became accredited by the National Commission on Muslim Filipinos (NCMF) and gained international recognition from Halal authorities in Malaysia (JAKIM), Singapore (MUIS), and Thailand (CICOT).

### Certification and Institutional Integrity

Central to Panumpang's vision was the institutionalization of **strict Halal certification processes** that involved physical inspections, product analysis, laboratory testing, and consultation with the Ulama Council (Muslim scholars) to ensure compliance with both Shari'ah Law and the Philippine National Standard on Halal.

He believed that Halal certification was not merely a compliance mechanism but a spiritual and institutional commitment to protect the integrity of Muslim economic life.

This work reflected his conviction that justice for Muslim Filipinos required creating parallel institutions (chambers of commerce, certification bodies, legal aid foundations) that could operate according to Shari'ah principles while interfacing with Philippine government and civil society.

### Global Market Integration and Inclusive Entrepreneurship

Panumpang actively pursued international recognition for Filipino Halal products, positioning the Philippines as a credible actor in the multi-trillion-dollar global Islamic economy.

He promoted Halal not as a niche market but as a "way of life" and economic model that benefited everyone, including non-Muslim business partners and consumers.

He championed programs to upskill Micro, Small, and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) in Halal standards, helping Filipino businesses tap into international Halal supply chains and markets.

This entrepreneurial vision was inseparable from his legal advocacy; he saw Halal economic development as a pathway to Muslim Filipino empowerment that required both institutional (HICCIP) and legal (PDCL, MUSLAID) scaffolding.

# Institutional Innovation and Community Organizing

## Networks and Diaspora Engagement

Panumpang was instrumental in organizing Muslim Filipino community associations abroad, particularly in Malaysia, to support the diaspora and maintain ties between overseas Filipinos and their home communities.

This work reflected a transnational vision of Muslim Filipino identity and collective welfare that transcended national borders.

## Professional Training and Capacity Building

Through NCMF partnerships and academic collaborations, Panumpang supported the development of professional training modules in Halal Industry and Islamic Banking.

These programs were designed not merely to produce technicians but to cultivate a corps of Muslim Filipino professionals equipped with both Shari'ah and contemporary business knowledge, capable of leading institutions that honored both systems.

# Legacy and Vision

Atty. Carim L. Panumpang, Sr.'s career embodied a distinctive philosophy of justice and development rooted in two core principles.

First, that Muslim Filipinos' rights and prosperity were inseparable from institutional recognition of Shari'ah principles and Islamic law.

Second, that this institutional recognition did not require separatism or conflict with Philippine national law, but rather creative legal pluralism, dialogue, and hybrid governance structures that honored both systems' integrity.

His work across agrarian reform, legal aid, and Halal industry development demonstrates that the pursuit of justice, economic inclusion, and cultural integrity for Muslim Filipinos is not a series of isolated challenges but an integrated vision of development.

A farmer's right to productive land, a widow's right to inherit under Shari'ah law, a Muslim entrepreneur's right to participate in the global economy according to Islamic principles, these were not separate struggles but expressions of a single commitment: ensuring that Muslim Filipinos could flourish as full participants in Philippine society without compromising their religious identity or values.

His legacy invites ongoing reflection on how the Philippine state and civil society can continue expanding institutional space for legal pluralism, Shari'ah-based development, and the kind of inclusive governance that honors both national law and religious tradition.

# Death

Atty. Carim L. Panumpang, Sr. passed away in August 2023.

His specific contributions during the transition to the Marcos administration (which began in June 2022) and the circumstances of his death remain publicly undocumented.

# Recognition

While Panumpang did not achieve widespread national prominence comparable to major political figures or celebrities, he commanded respect within Muslim Filipino legal and business circles.

His visibility was concentrated in specialized communities (agrarian reform beneficiaries, legal professionals, Halal industry practitioners, Muslim civil society organizations) rather than the general public.

# Further Reading

- NCMF Official Website and Publications
- Halal International Chamber of Commerce and Industries of the Philippines (HICCIP) Official Website
- Department of Agrarian Reform Historical Records and Press Releases
- Philippine Center for Islam and Democracy (PCID) Resources on Islamic Law in the Philippines
- Presidential Decree No. 1083: Code of Muslim Personal Laws

# See Also

- National Commission on Muslim Filipinos
- Code of Muslim Personal Laws
- Comprehensive Agrarian Reform Program
- Halal Certification in Southeast Asia
- Islamic Law in the Philippines
- Muslim Filipinos
- Bangsamoro Legal Traditions

# References

<ref name="DAR_Koronadal">Department of Agrarian Reform. "DAR assesses farmers' economic conditions, evaluates CARP impact in Koronadal City." DAR Official Website. Accessed 2019-2020.</ref>

<ref name="DAR_women">Department of Agrarian Reform Regional Office IV-A. "CALABARZON celebrates Women's Month." DEPDev Regional Office IV-A, March 10, 2020.</ref>

<ref name="DAR_land_distribution">Ochave, Revin Mikhael D. "DAR reduces land distribution duration to four months." BusinessWorld Online, March 1, 2021.</ref>

<ref name="DAR_Marawi">Mayuga, Jonathan L. "DAR readies distribution of 'idle' public lands to Marawi farmers." Business Mirror, April 1, 2021.</ref>

<ref name="HICCIP_2013">Philstar.com. "HICCIP to strengthen halal-based products." July 27, 2013.</ref>

<ref name="HICCIP_Inquirer">Inquirer Business. "HICCIP to strengthen Halal-based products." July 26, 2013.</ref>

<ref name="HICCIP_official">Halal International Chamber of Commerce and Industries of the Philippines. Official Website and Registration Documents. Accessed 2024.</ref>

<ref name="Manila_Standard_CLOA">Manila Standard. "DAR conducts CLOA validation." March 14, 2020.</ref>

<ref name="PNA_farmers">Philippine News Agency. "Over 2,000 Nueva Ecija farmers receive cash aid, farm implements." February 19, 2021.</ref>

**Editorial Notice:** BangsamoroPedia is a curated knowledge archive. Its pages are maintained by the editorial administrator to help ensure historical accuracy. If you would like to suggest corrections, share sources, or contribute information, please message the administrator through the official Facebook page: **Notable Muslim Filipinos**.

Retrieved from "https://wiki.maranaw.com/index.php?title=Carim_Panumpang,_Sr.&oldid=1651"